Medieval Archivists as Authors

Social Memory and Archival Memory

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Back in the early 1970s, David Hammack, a historian of New York City, told me that the most important person in the New York City Archives was an individual whose only qualification was his membership in the Teamsters Union. The reason that this was such an important qualification, Professor Hammack explained, was that the archive was seriously underfunded and underhoused. The most daunting task the staff faced each year was to get all of the materials that they had accumulated the previous year but could not possibly preserve to the city dump in time to make room for the next year's tidal wave of paper. The teamster/truck driver/archivist was the key to this activity.

Archivists do not generally like to dwell on their role as destroyers of the past. Normally, when talking about archives, one concentrates on preservation, not on destruction. However the New York City archivist-teamster illustrates an essential component in the relationship of the present to the past: the necessity of forgetting. Friedrich Nietzsche first called attention to the importance of forgetting, at least equal to remembering, speaking of “that malleable power of a person, a people, a culture, . . . to grow in new directions, to restructure and reconstitute what is past and foreign, to heal wounds, to replace what has been lost, and to recast those molds which have been broken.”[1]

Archivists are primary agents in this process, of necessity making choices about what is to be hauled to the landfill, what is to be preserved, and, perhaps as importantly, how it is to be preserved. We historians tend to prefer to ignore the fundamental role of archivists and enjoy the delusion that our clever research can bring us into some direct contact with the past. In fact, the work of historians is often constructed so as to make the archives invisible: to present the illusion of bringing the present reader into the past to which the historian, as interpreter and guide, has privileged access. In reality, historians are more likely than not providing their readers not with a tour of the past but with a tour of one or more archives, the creative work of teams or generations of archivists. It is they, through their process of selection, reorganization, and elimination, who largely determine what past can be accessed and, to a great extent, what that past might be. Archivists, one might well argue, are not preservers of their documents: they are their authors, engaged in work as creative, and as subjective, as that of those who originally penned individual texts or those modern historians who pretend to tell the past to the present.

As a medievalist, my ability to access my sources is always mitigated by archivists, most of whom are anonymous toilers in medieval monasteries and religious houses. In recent years I have come to pay more attention to them than I had in the past, asking about their role in the creation of the texts that they have transmitted to us. In this essay, I address one specific aspect of the work of medieval archivists, the compilation of cartularies or charter books, volumes that contain copies of the land records of medieval institutions, seen from the perspective not simply of preservation but of creation. I want to consider the compilers of these cartularies not as archivists but as authors.

At a very basic level, it is doubly absurd to talk about the authors of cartularies. First, we medievalists are accustomed to classifying cartularies among archival compilations Page 107 → rather than literary texts. They are largely copies of individual land transactions, donations, sales, exchanges, and the like, themselves the work of many scribes, or *scriptores*, writing on the order of a bishop, abbot, or other authority—over long periods of time and following specific legal or customary formulas—to record transactions normally involving the transfer of real property. We need not deny a certain creativity in the *narratio* of the charter itself, a certain literary sense of constructing reality by the scriptor, but even this mediocre level of creativity can hardly be assigned to the person who, decades or centuries later, recopied the charter into a cartulary. The cartulary, after all, exists at a secondary remove: at some point, as Wendy Davies beautifully showed in the case of the Redon cartulary, these individual

charters, perhaps lying in a chest or in the pigeonholes of a monastic archive, are collected and copied into a codex.[2] As photographs, as it were, of the contents of an archive at a particular moment, it would seem absurd to assign so weighty a designation as author to the compiler of this archival material.

If speaking of the author of a cartulary seems absurd to a medievalist, speaking of any author is apparently viewed as absurd by literary scholars. The Author, as understood in traditional literary studies, is widely pronounced to be dead or, rather, never to have lived except in what Roland Barthes called *positivist capitalist ideology*. Of course, word of this death has not spread everywhere. According to Barthes, this author "still reigns in manuals of literary history, in biographies of writers, magazine interviews, and in the very consciousness of litterateurs eager to unite, by means of private journals, their person and their work; The image of literature to be found in contemporary culture is tyrannically centered on the author, his person, his history, his tastes, his passions."[3] Since Mallarmé, Barthes argued, this tyranny of the author has been replaced by language: "It is language which speaks, not the author; to write is to reach, through a preliminary impersonality which we can at no moment identify with the realistic novelists' castrating 'objectivity,' at points where not 'I' but only language functions, 'performs.'"[4]

Michel Foucault also called this modern construct of the Author into question, but at the same time he questioned the alternative offered by Barthes, that is, to grant primary status not to the author but to writing: "In granting a primordial status to writing, do we not in effect, simply reinscribe in transcendental terms the theological affirmation of its sacred origin or a critical belief in its creative nature?"[5] "This conception of écriture sustains the privileges of the author through the safeguard of the a priori; the play of representations that formed a particular image of the author is extended within a gray neutrality. The disappearance of the author since Mallarmé, an event of our time, is held in check by the transcendental."[6]

Foucault proposed to go beyond the simple repetition of the empty slogan "the author has disappeared" and to examine the difficulties that arise in the use of an author's name. He suggested that the proper role of criticism, one might say scholarship, is not to reestablish the ties between an author and his or her work or to reconstitute an author's thought and experience through his or her works but rather that it should concern itself with the structures of a work studied for their intrinsic and internal relationships. But what, then, is a work if it is not something written by a person called an author? Moreover, is the "work" of an author everything that he or she wrote and said or only certain privileged texts?

We historians might well put aside for once our well-founded suspicion of theoreticians and recognize that Foucault is actually raising important questions for us when we consider this peculiar type of compilation that we call *cartularies*. Foucault's call to analyze verbal clusters as discursive layers that fall outside of the familiar categories of a book, a work, or an author is particularly fitting in the discussion of cartularies, precisely because they are at once self-contained and fall outside the normal category of individual documents. These are complex and problematic volumes, well worth our consideration within the context of a discussion of archival practice in the Middle Ages.

The problems raised by Foucault, and by our cartularies, are several. These include, first, the problem of proper names. What does it mean that we can attach the name *Anamot* to the tenth-century Regensburg archivist who completed a cartulary of the charters of his monastery around 893 ?[7] To call this, as historians regularly do, the "cartulary of Anamot" implies more than simply labeling the cartulary itself. To assign a name to a text is, as Foucault said, more than simply indicative: it is the equivalent of a description. "The proper name and the name of an author vacillate between the poles of description and designation,"[8] in this case pointing not only to the specific quires of a certain cartulary now in the Bavarian State Archives but also to a presumed person to whom can be assigned intentional motivations, a consistent personality, a history, somehow potentially manifest in the cartulary designated by his name. Is the purpose of scholarship to reestablish the ties between Anamot as author and his oeuvre, the cartulary, and thus Page 108 → to reconstitute his thought and experience through his work? But if not, if we refuse to ascribe anything but the work of mechanical compilation to the monk Anamot, then we must confront the question of why the monk ensured that his name would be a part of the cartulary. Can we address the question of intentionality and personality in such a case?

In the case of Anamot, the only extent text that we can in any circumstances attribute to him is the cartulary. Otherwise, he is entirely unknown. This is not always the case with authors or compilers of cartularies. What are we to make of the case of Cozroh, the ninth-century compiler or author of the so-called cartulary of Freising?[9] Cozroh appears not only as the "author" or compiler of the cartulary but also as the scriptor of over eighty charters he then himself recopied into the cartulary. Should we see him as the "author" of the cartulary in the same sense as "author" of the charters? Are we to look for some sort of program recognizable in both productions, or in neither? Is there a person we are describing or attempting to describe in the label *Cozroh*, or is this merely a representation of a traditional charge, executed according to standard formulas on the command of a bishop?

The issue becomes even more complex when one speaks of someone like Gregory of Catena (ca. 10601130), the "author" of the *Regestum Farfense*, that is, cartulary of Farfa,[10] as well as of the *Liber Largitorius*,[11] which registered grants made by Farfa to others, and of the *Chronicon Farfense*,[12] which synthesized and connected much of the material in both the *Liber Largitorius* and the *Regestum*.[13] Now, in the case of a name attached not only to charters and to a cartulary but to historical and polemical works as well, when one asks if Gregory can be termed the "author" of the cartulary, one is asking not simply about the relationship between a person (Gregory) and an administrative compilation but between a number of complex texts and their possible coherence. The issue, as Foucault expressed it, is important:

> A name can group together a number of texts and thus differentiate them from others. A name also establishes different forms of relationships among texts. Neither Hermes nor Hippocrates existed in the same sense that we can say Balzac existed, but the fact that a number of texts were attached to a single name implies that relationships of homogeneity, filiation, reciprocal explanation, authentication, or of common utilization were established among them.[14]

Thus to speak of Gregory as the "author" of the cartulary of Farfa is to make claims about the putative coherence of at least three texts belonging to different genres but constituting the author's oeuvre and thus implying reciprocal explanation if not homogeneity, and thus implying an intentional agency in their composition that constructs for us a unified discourse from which we postulate an individual.

What I propose to do is very briefly to address the author question in terms of these early cartularies, all begun before 1100, and all of which are attached to personal names: Cozroh, Anamot, and Gregory. In particular I want to consider how the prefatory materials in their cartularies and the active role of their compilers in selecting and organizing their material present the twin questions of authorship and authority. My real intention is not to decide whether the term *authorship* in the sense of Roland Barthes's positivist capitalist ideology is appropriate for describing cartulary production—one can easily assume from the start that this would be wildly anachronistic—but rather to illuminate to some extent the genesis and program of cartulary production in its first centuries. In effect, I argue that the relationship between the names that appear in these prefaces diffuses issues of authority and complicates the sense of purpose and intentionality behind these documents. They are neither the mechanical compilations of archives, photographs as it were of whatever archival drudges found in their keeping, nor are they the creations of individual personalities. Rather they represent the complex intersection of various personal and communal programs that cannot be reduced to a single author, a single *auctoritas*, or indeed a single purpose.

Pascale Bourgain and Marie-Clotilde Hubert have pointed out that cartularies, prior to the twelfth century, were generally (but not, I would argue, universally) considered rhetorical constructions.[15] Their prefaces are very similar to prefaces of historical and hagiographical works and appeal to the same topoi of self-abnegation, duty, and concern for the preservation of the past that one ands in these other contemporary genres. Indeed, in so-called chronicle cartularies the very distinction of genre is entirely arbitrary: a text such as the *Gesta abbatum S. Bertini Sithiensium*, composed by Folquin, is explicitly called a "history of the abbots" of St. Bertin, although it is composed primarily of charters Folquin copied from his monastery's archives.[16] But rather than talking about these explicitly narrative cartularies, I focus on those that are indeed copies of charters not sewn together by a narrative. A number of these contain prefaces, some fairly Page 109 → elaborate. They present a justification and even an apology for their composition and allude to the question of authority and necessity in ways that are both significant and, perhaps, disingenuous. Let's begin at the beginning with the cartulary of Freising, one of the

earliest extant cartularies, begun by the deacon Cozroh in the 830s.

According to his preface, the cartulary was compiled on the command of Bishop Hitto of Freising (811-35), who was eager to have written down in a single book “whatever he found written in individual charters and confirmed by other testimonies, both from the times of the preceding fathers as well as from his own famous rule.” In a real sense, then, the *auctor* of the cartulary was not Cozroh but Hitto himself. Cozroh's own role was simply that of the instrument of Hitto's will:

> And for this task, not mean but laudable, which he initiated, he sought out and found his own meanest little servant, yet still his most faithful, named Cozroh, whom he taught by his own sacred teachings, and promoted to the dignity of the priesthood. And placing upon him the weight of so great a labor, he instructed him in that way firmly to accomplish this task with care and with all circumspection: He found nothing diminished or added to, unless it was something that had been corrupted through the fault of the scribe. And he himself, conscious of his own lack of skill, as if mildly resisting, but preferring both to obey his kind instructions than to flee the weight of so great a care, with the Lord assisting, began this work.[17]

Cozroh did not explain that the choice of him as the compiler of the cartulary was most appropriate: he had been acting as a scribe, preparing charters for Freising since 820. Moreover, his duties continued after the death of Hitto until 848. However, the final compilation of the cartulary, if perhaps undertaken at the command of Hitto, was not completed for over twenty years after the disappearance of the bishop. This is evident, for example, in the treatment of one document for which Cozroh had acted as scribe and that he had later included in the cartulary. A consideration of how this document passed from original to cartulary copy suggests the complexity hidden in Cozroh's disingenuous claim that in making his cartulary he had simply followed Bishop Hitto's directions “nothing diminished or added to, unless it was something that had been corrupted through the fault of the scribe.”[18]

The document records the resolution of a dispute between Bishop Erchanbert of Freising, nephew and successor of Hitto who assumed the episcopacy in 836, and the heirs of a certain Kiso in the 840s.[19] The bishop had claimed that Kiso had donated a church at Strogn and property at Berghofen to the church of Freising. Kiso's heirs, Vuichelm and Eigil, disputed the claim. However, the bishop was able to call witnesses in support of his claim, and “convicted and coerced by the laws” Vuichelm and Eigil returned the property. Some time later, however, the two appeared before the bishop and requested to be allowed to join allodial property at Berghofen that they had inherited from Kiso, to their father's gift. In return, Eigil and his mother received the properties at Strogn as life benefices.

Such a dispute and such a resolution are not at all unusual for mid-ninth-century Freising and have been analyzed in terms of Bavarian dispute resolution by Warren Brown.[20] What is peculiar is that the document that records the event is in the form not of a typical episcopal placita or of a formal *gueriptio* (or quitclaim) but rather of a narrative combining the story of two separate events. Moreover, although it concludes, “Ego Kozroh indignus presbiter scripsi,” it seems to have been written or revised long after the date indicated: June 9, 840. By the time the document in its present form was written, Bishop Erchanbert was dead: it begins, “Quomodo quidem reverendae memoriae Erchanbertus episcopus et advocatus eius Kerhart quaesierunt unam ecclesiam at Stroagnon” (In what manner Bishop Erchanbertus of blessed memory and his advocate Kerhart claimed a church at Strognon). At a second point in the text, Erchanbert is referred to as *memoratus episcopus*, terminology that implies that he is dead at the time of the writing. The document must have received its final form sometime after Erchanbert's death in 854. Had Cozroh been present to record the events at the original placitum or at the subsequent renegotiation of the grant? One can doubt it: Cozroh used a series of formulas to designate by what authority he served as scribe. In twenty-one cases he stated that he wrote “on the order of the bishop.”[21] In seventeen others, he explained that he was present and that he had written the charter after having “seen and heard” the events described.[22] In twenty-two cases, he combined the two formulas.[23] Only in ten charters did he fail to appeal either to the authority of the bishop or to his own witness but rather, as in our case, wrote simply, “Ego Cozroh indignus presbiter scripsi” (I the unworthy priest Cozroh wrote this).[24] Perhaps these formulas are

without meaning, but they may suggest that Cozroh had written the final version of the notice by combining two earlier texts of which he had not been the original scriptor. The composition of this narrative, composed not only long after the death of the bishop on whose command Cozroh claimed to have begun the cartulary but over a decade after the events it describes, suggests that Page 110 → Cozroh was at least adjusting and clarifying, if not perhaps writing or revising, his own earlier version of the events, if indeed such an earlier version ever had existed.

Is then Cozroh the author of his cartulary in a way that is different from his authorship of the charters that he composed, having "seen and heard" the events that they describe? His work is somewhere between compiler and creator. On what *auctoritas* did he pursue this work? According to his claims, the authority derived from Hitto, who first ordered the cartulary to be written. The mandate to Cozroh to produce the cartulary can only with difficulty be ascribed to Hitto: it was a project carried on under at least three different bishops, and one intimately related to Cozroh's role in the community. In attributing the impulse of the cartulary to a long-dead bishop, Cozroh was transferring the authority from himself to one who could not be responsible for the content of much of what he wrote. Just as the copies of the charters themselves point beyond to original charters, charters perhaps (in Cozroh's words) in danger of removal or destruction either through carelessness or by fraud, the authority of this collection points to a person long dead but whose intention to renew the written treasures of the church of Freising, its copies of sacred scripture, its liturgical texts, and the memory of its benefactors serves as transposed guarantor of the authority of this undertaking.

One sees a similar transposition of authority from the initiative of the compiler to a deceased *auctoritas* in the cartulary of Anamot, fragmentarily but tantalizingly preserved in Munich. Like Cozroh, Anamot's dedicatory preface attributes the cartulary to the initiative of his bishop Ambricho.[25] Like Cozroh, by the time the cartulary was completed, Ambricho and his successor were both dead. The authority of the compilation rests then with the departed, and the cartulary is a memorial to their memory.

Originally the cartulary, composed around 895, began with a memorial poem addressed to Ambricho and, unusually for the period, a portrait of the bishop on opposite folios, now folios 70V and 71r of the manuscript:

> Behold here the beautiful form of the venerable bishop
> Who often favored us with sacred kindness
> Whose honor shines forth abroad through the wide
> world,
> . . .
>
> Omnipotent God, who placed the rulers of the world
> Return to him full rewards for his good deeds
> May he gain the special gifts of this small little book
> In heaven, where true hope extends.[26]

Following the table of contents of the first book is a second dedication to the bishop:

> To the most excellent lord bishop A. Anamot his humble servant.
>
> Since I knew that your mind was always occupied with all types of study of books and with all other forms of service of the divine cult, I tried with all my effort to present this little work into the beautiful hands of your holiness. Gathering together several charters of gifts, exchanges, and sales, I brought them into the single volume of the present little collection so that, having removed error, the charters might, when necessary, be more easily located and comprehended by chapter headings.[27]

As in Cozroh's preface, the impulse for the composition of the collection is placed within a general interest on the part of the bishop in the books and texts in the service of God. It is the devotion of the bishop that brought into being the collection of charters. However, again as in Cozroh's cartulary, the bishop had died before the completion of the volume. Remarkably, in Regensburg either Anamot or a contemporary decided that this

dedication need not apply only to Ambricho. Although still recognizable, the name of the bishop has been scraped out to the first letter—A. The editor Josef Widemann suggested that after Ambricho's death in 891 a decision was made simply to insert that of his successor, Aspert, into this space. Aspert died shortly after, in 984, and this may explain why the space was never filled in.[28] Did Anamot change his dedication to flatter a new patron? We cannot conclude this. Widemann suggested that Anamot had dedicated “his cartulary” to Ambricho but that the collection was continued to include charters from the episcopacy of Aspert and that Anamot's dedication was at first simply copied in the later copies but the name of the dedicatee was intended to be changed after the fact. It is impossible to know. The poetic dedication implies that Ambricho was already dead at the time of its composition, but there is no particular reason to assume that Anamot might not have been involved in the copying of the cartulary. It is simply impossible to ascribe either the “authority” of the cartulary to either bishop or to ascribe the authorship to an individual named Anamot. Bishops seem to have been interchangeable, and the name of the “author,” Anamot, may have been but a convention representing a series of compilers of the collection.

Gregory of Catena belongs in many ways to another world from that of Anamot and Cozroh. He lived and wrote in the heat of the investiture controversy that drew Page 111 → Farfa into protracted conflict with the reform papacy and the empire, and the collections that he produced are an integral part of these conflicts.[29] One finds nevertheless a continuity in the complex, discursive layers, on the shifting borders between narrative, polemical treatise, and administrative record—a complex of intertextual references that fall outside of the familiar categories of a book, a work, or an author.

Gregory's rich work and complex career have drawn the attention of scholars for over a century. According to his preface to the *Regestum*, Gregory, at the age of thirty-two, suggested to the abbot Bernard II and to the older monks that they authorize him to organize all of the documents relating to the monastery's rights. The result was a two-volume compendium (the *Regestum Farfense*) he entitled both *Liber Gemniagraphus*, which he explained as the “memorial of the description of the lands,” and the *Claeronomalem*, or the “inheritance of the church of Farfa.”[30] This was no simple transcription of charters. Like Cozroh and Anamot, Gregory felt free to edit documents to improve their Latin or to elucidate content that he considered no longer clear. Whether he went beyond these emendations to actually changing the content is likely if not entirely provable. Certainly his selections of documents represented the exercise of judgment and discrimination, as did his decision to copy into the register a collection of canons supporting Farfa's rights. Some have seen Gregory as the “author” or inventor of these canons, although they seem to have been drawn from an earlier collection, much in the way that the eleventh-century cartulary of St. Denis includes a canonical collection in support of that monastery's rights. The charters and the canons were intended as a whole, each implicitly referring to the other and mutually supporting monastic rights against papal or episcopal encroachment.[31]

In addition to his register, Gregory also undertook the *Liber Largitorius*, a register of grants from Farfa to others, including the period of the grant, the conditions, and the value of the property. Gregory's work was continued by his nephew Todinus around 1125, who not only added subsequent concessions but earlier ones that Gregory had omitted.

Using both the *Regestum* and the *Liber Largitorius*, Gregory then compiled the *Chronicon Farfense*, a narrative that was, even more than the *Liber Largitorius*, a collaborative effort involving Gregory, Todinus, and other, unidentified scribes bringing the history of the monastery to 1118. Finally, in 1130, he began his *Liber Floriger*, a condensed history of the monastery drawn from the *Chronicon* and the *Regestum* that also provided a topographical index relating to charters he had copied into the other volumes.[32]

All of the works were deeply interrelated: Gregory himself referred to the *Chronicon* as the “third book of charters” (*Hunc cartularum tertium librum*), and together their historical, archival, and canonical content constantly pointed to originals in the monastery's archives, in canonical collections, or in the other volumes composed by Gregory or one of his collaborators. Their authority derives from the solicited request for composition made by Gregory to Abbot Berardus and to the alleged care with which Gregory, who professed little learning (and thus, presumably, little powers of invention) copied the contents of his materials. Indeed, although Gregory composed a preface to the *Regestum*, its more formal prologue was not written by him but by Johannes

Grammaticus, sometime before 1120. This prologue modifies slightly the information in the first-person preface by Gregory. Here, there is no mention of Gregory's request to be ordered to compile the volume. Instead one learns that “inspired by divine grace, it pleased lord Berardus the most reverend abbot of this church . . . to collect together all of the privileges and precepts and laws and legal charters of great age now almost entirely destroyed and having most accurately transcribed them to bequeath them to the memory of posterity.” Iohannes, assuming the persona of Abbot Berardus in the third-person plural, then assured that “in copying them we have neither added, nor subtracted nor changed anything, but having corrected those corrupted parts rhetorically in respect to how they had been written, we have given them over legally through the hands of our most wise fellow brother Gregory.”[33] There then follows, as in the preface to the Regensburg cartulary, a poetic dedication and a donor portrait. However, in contrast to the dedicatory verses and portrait of Regensburg at the end of the ninth century, this poem honors not Abbot Berardus but Gregory, and the portrait shows him presenting the *Regestum* to the Virgin Mary.

One can hardly make firm conclusions based on a discussion of three cartularies. But we can see that these archival compilations are very complex creations that always point to something beyond themselves. They are not the sum of anything but spill over into other texts. They are essential intertextual references. In theory, anyone who doubts the authority of the cartulary can simply consult the originals. This is the suggestion presented in the preface to the cartulary of Saint-Amand: “If anyone doubts this, let him examine the ancient charters.”[34] Actually, as the prefaces of Cozroh and others suggest, the Page 112 → originals were often so badly damaged that they were illegible, if they still existed at all. This was after all one of the reasons for compiling cartularies in the first place. Moreover, cartularies never contain all of the charters of an institution, and they do not always reproduce all of the content of the originals. Moreover, as in the case of the account of the Bavarian conflict apparently composed by Cozroh, they contain documents written specifically for inclusion in the cartulary. Alone they are sometimes mere catalogs and can only be understood in their use in coordination with the originals to which they refer, but yet they purport to contain these originals. As for their compilers, even those who left their names in association with these collections were both more and less than authors. They claimed authority from without—from their abbot or bishop; authority too was vested in the referred to but invisible originals, although these might have been emended in a variety of subtle ways for present usage. Cartularies were collaborative efforts, existing at the intersection of individual expertise, command, and collaborative execution, as were all manuscripts of the Middle Ages. At the same time, if the persons whose names are associated with the collections were involved in (if not directly responsible for) their inception, they were not likely to be present at their end, if they ever did end—additions could be made and new signatures or volumes added but not necessarily in accord with an original system devised at the outset. Should Gregory be seen as the author of the *Regestum*, or perhaps Berardus, whose *auctoritas* made it possible? Or possibly Johannes Grammaticus, the “author” of its second prologue? Or perhaps it is the Presbyter Petrus, who is shown in the donor portrait offering the price of the first charter: “Presbiteri Petri sunt haec primordia libri / Solidos nanque decem pro cartis optulit ipse.” The modern, romantic notion of authorship is too thin a construct to encompass the complexities hidden behind a Cozroh, an Anamot, or a Gregory. They exist at the intersection of piety, obedience, expediency, collectivity, and memory.

NOTES

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1. Friedrich Nietzsche, *Vom Nutzen und Nachtheil der Historie für das Leben*, vol. 2, *Nietzsches Werke, Klassiker Ausgabe* (Leipzig, 1922), 134.
2. Wendy Davies, “The Composition of the Redon Cartulary,” *Francia* 17 (1990): 69–90. In his introduction to *La Cartulaire de l'abbaye Saint-Sauveur de Redon* (Rennes, 1998), 9–25, Hubert Guillotel recognized “un projet cohérent encore qu'à première vue énigmatique, don't la responsabilité doit être attribuée à l'abbé Aumond,” and he spoke of a *copiste* who “had to put his work in order” (17), but he attributed no creativity to this anonymous figure.

3. Roland Barthes, *Le bruissement de la langue: essais critiques IV* (Paris, 1984), 62.
4. Barthes, *Le bruissement de la langue*, 62.
5. Michel Foucault, "Qu'est-ce qu'un auteur?" *Bulletin de la Société française de Philosophie* 63 (1969): 80.
6. Foucault, "Qu'est-ce qu'un auteur?" 79.
7. Bayerische Hauptstaatsarchiv St. Emmeram KL Lit. 5 1/3. On the manuscript see Patrick Geary, "Entre Gestion et gesta," in *Les cartulaires: Actes de la Table ronde organisée par l'École nationale des chartes et le G.D.R. 121 du C.N.R.S. (Paris, 5–7 décembre, 1991)*, ed. O. Guyotjeannin, L. Morelle, and M. Parisse, Mémoires et documents de l'École des Chartes, 39 (Paris, 1993), 13–24, esp. 23; and Patrick Geary, *Phantoms of Remembrance: Memory and Oblivion at the End of the First Millennium* (Princeton: 1994), 98–100.
8. Foucault, "Qu'est-ce qu'un auteur?" 81.
9. Bayerische Hauptstaatsarchiv Hochstift Freising Lit. 3a. See Geary, "Entre Gestion et gesta," 20–23, and *Phantoms of Remembrance*, 96–98.
10. Biblioteca Apostolica Vaticana, Vat. Lat., 8487.
11. Biblioteca Nationale Vittorio Emanuele, MS Farfa 3.
12. Biblioteca Nazionale Vittorio Emanuele, MS Farfa 1.
13. On the texts of Gregory see Ildefonso Schuster, *Abbazia di Farfa: Contributo allo studio del ducato romano nel M. Evo* (Rome: 1921; 1987), 1:21–23; Theo Kölzer, *Collectio canonum Regestro Farfensi inserta*, Monumenta Iuris Canonici, série B: Corpus Collectionum, vol. 5 (Città del Vaticana: 1982), 7–9; Theo Kölzer, "Codex libertatis: Überlegungen zur Funktion des 'Regestum Farfense' und andere Kloster cartulare," in *Atti del Congresso internazionale di studi sull'alto medioevo*, Centro Italiano di Studi sull'alto medioevo (Spoleto: 1983), 2:609–53; and Mary Stroll, *The Medieval Abbey of Farfa: Target of Papal and Imperial Ambitions*, Brill's Studies in Intellectual History (Leiden: 1997), 7–15. For the context of Gregory's work within Italian historiography of the period see Walter Pohl, *Werkstätte der Erinnerung: Montecassino und die Gestaltung der langobardischen Vergangenheit* (Vienna: 2001), esp. 152–62.
14. Foucault, "Qu'est-ce qu'un auteur?" 82–83.
15. Pascale Bourgain and Marie-Clotilde Hubert, "Latin et rhétorique dans les préfaces de cartulaire," in *Les cartulaires*, 115–36.
16. B. Guérard, ed., *Cartulaire de l'abbaye de Saint-Bertin*, Documents inédits, Collection des cartulaires de France, 3 (Paris, 1840); O. Holder-Egger, ed., *Gesta abbatum s. Bertini Sithiensium*, MGH SS, XIII (Hanovre, 1881), 607–34; and Hariulf, *Chronique de l'abbaye de Saint-Riquier (Ve siècle-1104)*, ed. Ferdinand Lot, Collection de textes pour servir à l'étude et à l'enseignement de l'histoire (Paris, 1894). See Laurent Morelle, "Les chartes dans la gestion des conflits (France du nord, XIe-début du XIIe siècle)," in *Pratiques de l'écrit documentaire Page 113 → au XIe siècle*, ed. O. Guyotjeannin, L. Morelle, and M. Parisse, Bibliothèque de l'École des chartes, t. 155 (1997), 267–98; and "Histoire et archives vers l'an mil: Une nouvelle 'mutation'?" *Histoire et archives* 3 (1998): 130–31.
17. "Quicquid singulis cartulis exaratum certisque testimoniis confirmatum invenit, uno volumine rationabiliter includere studuit tam antecessorum patrum temporibus quam etiam sui famosi regiminis." Theodor Bitterauf, ed., *Die Traditionen des Hochstifts Freising*, Quellen und Erörterungen zur bayerischen und deutschen Geschichte, neue Folge Bd. 4 (Munich, 1905; 1967), 2 (hereafter *TF*).
18. "Hoc tamen opus non vile, sed laudabile cui commisisset inquisivit invenitque tamen suum vilissimum servulum, sed tamen sui fidelissimum, nomine Cozroh, quem tamen ipse suis sacris disciplinis edocuit, et ad presbiterii dignitatem provexit. Inponensque ei pondus tanti laboris, sollicite ac omni circumspectione hoc opus peragere, eo modo armiter praecipiens: nihil minui vel adici, nisi scribtoris vitio aliquid depravatum repperisset." Ibid.
19. *TF*, 636.
20. Warren Brown, "The Use of Norms in Disputes in Early Medieval Bavaria," *Viator* 30 (1999): 15–41. See more generally on this cartulary his *Unjust Seizure: Conflict, Interest, and Authority in an Early Medieval Society* (Ithica, 2001).
21. iussus a domno: *TF*, 462, 485, 487, 492, 499a, 501b, 515, 519, 522 (Ego Hitto . . . praecepi Cozrohe presbitero nostro et ipse sicut praecepi perfecit), 523a, 529, 533, 535, 538, 542, 549, 553, 555, 557, 571, 572, 587, 609, 611, 651, 655, 678, 686.
22. hoc videns et audiens: *TF*, 440, 554, 576a, 582, 583, 590, 601, 602, 603, 604, 626, 671, 672, 676, 679,

689, 699.
23. hoc videns et audiens conscripsi iussione: *TF*, 547c, 556, 559, 573, 580, 581b, 587, 594, 596, 598, 599, 606, 607a, 615b, 634, 660, 664, 667, 674, 680, 698, 701. In praesentia Hittonis episcopi ego Cozroh conscripsi: 588b.
24. Scripsi: *TF*, 486, 498, 531, 536, 560, 562, 600, 627, 628, 636.
25. Josef Widemann, ed., *Die Traditionen des Hochstifts Regensburg und des Klosters S. Emmeram*, Quellen und Erörterungen zur bayerischen Geschichte neue Folge Bd. 8 (Munich, 1934; 1988), vii–ix (hereafter *TR*).
26. Versus Anamodi: "Presulis hic pulchram venerandi cernite formam, / Qui nobis sacro sepe fauet merito, / Cuius honor mundo iste prefulget in amplo, / . . . Cui deus omnipotens, mundi qui regmina ponis, / Premia de factis reddito plena bonis! / Istius et parui specalia dona libellil / In celis capiat, spes vbi vera patet." *TR*, viii.
27. EXCELLENTISSIMO DOMINO A . . . EPISCOPO ANAMOTVS HVMILLIMVS FAMVLVS. Uestram igitur mentem, quoniam in omni librorum studio ceteroque diuini cultus mancipatu semper inherere cognoueram, hoc opusculum ultronea uoluntate pulcherrimis sanctitatis uestre manibus presentare conabar. *TR*, xiii.
28. *TR*, xiii.
29. See the bibliography in n. 10 and the literature cited by Stroll, *The Medieval Abbey of Farfa*, 8–11.
30. "Porro huic libro GEMNIAGRAPHUM nomen imposuimus, idest MEMORIAM DESCRIPTIONIS TERRARUM, quia in eo huius coenobii terras a quocumque, uel ubicumque acquisitas inseruimus, et eas ad semper memorandum in uno uolumine comprehendimus. Placuit etiam nobis et CLAERONOMALEM, id est haereditalem pharphesis AECCLESIAE appellari, quoniam proprias ipsius immobiles ab initio libere demonstrat possessiones." I. Giorgi e U. Balzani, ed., *Il regesto di Farfa compilato da Gregorio di Catino* (Rome: 1879), 2:6–7; and Stroll, *The Medieval Abbey of Farfa*, 8.
31. See Kölzer, *Collectio Canonum;* and Stroll, *The Medieval Abbey of Farfa*, 9, n. 20.
32. Stroll, *The Medieval Abbey of Farfa*, 10–12.
33. "Diuina inspirante gratia, placuit domno Berardo reuerentissimo abbati huius aecclesiae pharphensis mobilissima gente progentio florentiae urbis, quatinus istius sacri coenobii uniuersa priuilegia et praecepta nec non et tomos et legales cartas nimmia uaetustate iam pene consumpta, in unum uolumen colligere eaque ad memoriam posteritatis studiosissime declarata, uaeracissime transcripta relinquere. Et hoc prudentissimo actum est consilio, ne forte, quod saepissime iam euenisse nouimus, aut custodum negligentia, aut uaetustate consumente nimia, prae dicta obliuioni traderentur praecepta, tomi, cartae, et privilegia. Quae ueraciter elucubrando nichil eis omnio addidimus, uel minuimus, nec mutauimus, sed corruptis partibus rethorice emendatis, eo respectu quo scripta erant, ea legaliter transtulimus per manus confraatris nostri magnae sagacitatis Gregorii sabinensi comitatu oriundi, in castro catinensi nobilissimis parentibus progeniti, et nostrae aecclesiae fere ab ispa infantia lacte enuriti." *Il regestro*, 2:20.
34. H. Platelle, "Le premier cartulaire de l'abbaye de Saint Amand," *Le Moyen Age* 62 (1956): 318–19. See also Morelle, "Histoire et archives vers l'an mil," 131.